

Glorification

doc-glorification

Soteriology · Glorification · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

score 1.000
confidence high

Statement under examination

At Christ's return, believers will be raised bodily, transformed, and glorified: the final consummation of salvation in resurrection bodies free from sin and decay.

In plain language

The Greek vocabulary across Paul and John supports the proposition with high consistency. Romans 8:30 ends a chain of four matching past-tense verbs with edoxasen, he glorified, so the final glory is spoken of as already settled, even though the same chapter at verse 18 calls that glory still about to be revealed. First Corinthians 15:42 to 57 builds a sustained set of opposites. The body is sown in corruption, phthora, and raised in incorruption, aphtharsia. It is sown in dishonor and raised in glory, doxa. It is sown in weakness and raised in power. It is sown a soulish body and raised a spiritual body. The same noun soma, body, stays through every line, so this is the transformation of the body, not a swap for something non-bodily. Verse 53 says the corruptible must put on incorruption and the mortal must put on immortality, using a clothing image with the word dei, it is necessary. Verse 51 says we shall all be changed at the last trumpet. Verse 54 quotes Isaiah 25:8 that death is swallowed up into victory. Philippians 3:21 says Christ will refashion the body of our lowliness so that it is conformed, symmorphon, to the body of his glory, and First John 3:2 says we shall be like him, using the adjective homoios, because we shall see him as he is. Romans 8:18 to 23 widens the same hope to creation, which awaits the freedom of the glory of the children of God, and ties it to the redemption of the body. Two honest notes explain why readers can still differ on detail without touching the verdict. First, the words that specifically say the believer is glorified or conformed, the verb doxazo applied to us and the rare term symmorphos, are individually scarce, so the certainty comes from the whole pattern agreeing rather than from any single frequent word. Second, the timing and scheme of these events are not ranked by the vocabulary itself, which is where divergence lives. The lexical evidence is dense, repeated, and spread across several letters.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
G0076	Ἀδάμ	Adam	Adam	
G0110	ἀθανασία	athanasia	immortality	3
G0236	ἀλλάσσω	allasso	to change	6
G0444	ἄνθρωπος	anthrōpos	a human	
G0553	ἀπεκδέχομαι	apekdechomai	to expect	8
G0861	ἀφθαρσία	aphtharsia	incorruptibility	8
G1391	δόξα	doxa	glory	170
G1392	δοξάζω	doxazo	to glorify	62
G1453	ἐγείρω	egeiro	to arise	147

G1746	ἐνδύω	enduo	to put on	29
G2032	ἐπουράνιος	epouranios	heavenly	19
G2227	ζωοποιέω	zōopoieō	to make alive	
G2288	θάνατος	thanatos	death	121
G2937	κτίσις	ktisis	creation	19
G3345	μετασχηματίζω	metaschematizo	to transform	5
G3534	νίκος	nikos	victory	4
G3664	ὅμοιος	homoios	like	46
G3666	ὁμοίω	homoioō	to liken	
G4152	πνευματικός	pneumatikos	spiritual	26
G4687	σπείρω	speiro	to sow	56
G4832	σύμμορφος	symmorphos	conformed	2
G4983	σῶμα	soma	body	144
G5356	φθορά	phthora	corruption	9
G5517	χοϊκός	choikos	made of dust	4
G5591	ψυχικός	psychikos	natural	6

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

The Pauline aorist chain in Rom 8:30 closes with edoxasen, he glorified, placing glorification as the terminal link of the salvific sequence, stated in the same aorist tense of certainty as the prior verbs proorisen, ekalesen, edikaïosen. 1 Cor 15:42 to 57 builds a sustained antithetical lexical field, phthora versus aphtharsia, atimia versus doxa, astheneia versus dunamis, psychikon versus pneumatikon, thnetos versus athanasia, with the verbs egeiretai, allagesometha, and endusasathai naming the resurrection transformation while the noun soma is retained throughout. Phil 3:21 caps it with metaschematisei to soma and symmorphon to somati tes doxes autou, and 1 John 3:2 with homoioi auto esometha anchored to seeing him as he is. Rom 8:18 to 23 extends the hope to creation under phthora awaiting eleutheria tes doxes and the apolytrosin tou somatos. The pattern is dense and pan-canonical across the Pauline and Johannine corpora and is not variant-sensitive at the verdict level. The verb doxazo applied to the believer and the term symmorphos are individually rare, so the certainty rests on the convergence of the whole field rather than on the frequency of any single term.

Scripture

Rom.8.30 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1392 δοξάζω

Force. Aorist chain proorisen, ekalesen, edikaïosen, edoxasen places edoxasen, he glorified, as the terminal proleptic act of the order of salvation, stated in the same aorist tense as the prior links so that the future glory is spoken of as already certain. Of the 62 canon uses of doxazo, the believer is the object of final glorification in only a handful, chiefly here and Rom 8:17, so the term is decisive here but not frequent.

Rom.8.29 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4832 σύμμορφος

Force. Proorisen symmorphous tes eikonos tou huiou autou. The believer is predestined to be conformed to the image of the Son. This is one of only two canon uses of symmorphos, and it sets up the same conformity that Phil 3:21 will give to the resurrection body, making the verdict-bearing conformity language pan-Pauline rather than isolated.

1Cor.15.42 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G4687 σπείρω, G1453 ἐγείρω, G5356 φθορά, G0861 ἀφθαρσία

Force. Antithetical pairing speiretai en phthora, egeiretai en aphtharsia binds resurrection to incorruption, with present passive verbs marking divine agency.

1Cor.15.43 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G1391 δόξα, G1453 ἐγείρω

Force. Speiretai en atimia, egeiretai en doxe and speiretai en astheneia, egeiretai en dunamei extend the antithetical column, naming doxa as the state into which the body is raised.

1Cor.15.44 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4983 σῶμα, G5591 ψυχικός, G4152 πνευματικός

Force. Soma psychikon versus soma pneumatikon. The retained noun soma rules out disembodied survival, while the adjectives mark the qualitative transformation of the same body. Psychikos is rare, 6 uses, but its contrast partner pneumatikos and the kept noun soma fix the sense as animated-by-soul versus animated-by-Spirit.

1Cor.15.45 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0076 Ἀδάμ, G0444 ἄνθρωπος

Force. First-Adam, last-Adam typology: ho protos anthropos Adam eis psychen zosan, ho eschatos Adam eis pneuma zoopoion. The last Adam is the source of the life-giving spirit that powers the resurrected body.

1Cor.15.47 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G5517 χοϊκός, G0444 ἄνθρωπος

Force. Ho protos anthropos ek ges choikos, ho deuterus anthropos ex ouranou. The earthy versus heavenly polarity grounds the two-body taxonomy in two representative humans. Choikos, earthy, made of dust, occurs only 4 times, all in this paragraph, so its sense is set by this context alone.

1Cor.15.49 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G5517 χοϊκός, G2032 ἐπουράνιος

Force. Kathos ephoresamen ten eikona tou choikou, phoresomen kai ten eikona tou epouraniou. The verb names the believer's assumption of the heavenly image, with eikon, image, linking back to symmorphous tes eikonos in Rom 8:29.

1Cor.15.50 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G5356 φθορά, G0861 ἀφθαρσία

Force. Sarx kai haima basileian theou kleronomesai ou dynatai, oude he phthora ten aphtharsian kleronomei. The inheritance of the kingdom requires the corruption-to-incorruption transition.

1Cor.15.51 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0236 ἀλλάσσω

Force. Pantēs allagesometha. The future passive plural locates the change as a future divine act on all who are Christ's. Allasso is used 6 times, twice here in vv 51 to 52 of this transformation.

1Cor.15.52 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1453 ἐγείρω, G0236 ἀλλάσσω

Force. Hoi nekroi egerthesontai aphthartoi, kai hemeis allagesometha. The dead are raised incorruptible and the living are changed at the eschatological trumpet.

1Cor.15.53 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G1746 ἐνδύω, G0861 ἀφθαρσία, G0110 ἀθανασία

Force. Dei gar to phtharton touto endusasthai aphtharsian kai to thneton touto endusasthai athanasian. The clothing image names what must be put on, with dei marking divine necessity. Athanasia, immortality, occurs only 3 times, but the paired aphtharsia and the verb endusasthai fix the sense.

1Cor.15.54 · for · genre: epistle · figures: metaphor

Key terms. G2288 θάνατος, G3534 νίκος

Force. Katepothe ho thanatos eis nikos quotes Isa 25:8. Death is swallowed up into victory at the donning of incorruption.

1Cor.15.57 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3534 νίκος

Force. To didonti hemin to nikos dia tou kyriou hemon Iesou Christou. The victory over death is given through Christ, securing the resurrection outcome.

Phil.3.21 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3345 μετασχηματίζω, G4832 σύμμορφος, G4983 σῶμα, G1391 δόξα

Force. Metaschematisei to soma tes tapeinoseos hemon symmorphon to somati tes doxes autou. The verb metaschematizo, to change in fashion, takes soma as its object, and symmorphos, conformed to with the dative, names the result. Symmorphos occurs only here and Rom 8:29, so its two uses both point to conformity to Christ, making the sense stable despite the rarity.

1John.3.2 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3664 ὅμοιος

Force. Homoioi auto esometha, hoti opsometha auton kathos estin. The future state is likeness to the appearing Christ, with sight of him as he is as the formative cause. The word is homoios, the adjective like or resembling, 46 canon uses, not the verbal homoioo of the parable formulas, so the claim is qualitative likeness to Christ.

Rom.8.18 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1391 δόξα

Force. Ouk axia ta pathemata tou nyn kairou pros ten mellousan doxan apokalyphthenai eis hemas. Present suffering is set against a coming glory yet to be revealed into us.

Rom.8.21 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2937 κρίσις, G5356 φθορά, G1391 δόξα

Force. He ktisis eleutherothesetai apo tes douleias tes phthoras eis ten eleutherian tes doxes ton teknon tou theou. Creation itself is brought into the glory-freedom of the children of God.

Rom.8.23 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0553 ἀπεκδέχομαι, G4983 σῶμα

Force. Apekdechomenoi huiiothesian, ten apolytosin tou somatos hemon. The hoped-for adoption is identified with the redemption of the body, naming bodily resurrection as the content of glorification.

Col.3.4 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1391 δόξα

Force. Hotan ho Christos phanerothe, tote kai hymeis syn auto phanerothesesthe en doxe. When Christ is manifested, the believers are manifested with him in glory. The cross-reference network ties this directly to 1 John 3:2 and Phil 3:21, repeating the appearing-then-glory sequence.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
1Cor.15.54	Isa.25.8	tsk	1
1Cor.15.54	Isa.25.8	openbible	1
1Cor.15.55	Hos.13.14	tsk	1
1Cor.15.55	Job.18.13	tsk	1
Phil.3.21	Isa.25.8	tsk	1
Phil.3.21	1John.3.2	openbible	1
Phil.3.21	Hos.13.14	openbible	1
Phil.3.21	Col.3.4	openbible	1
1John.3.2	Rom.8.29	openbible	1
1John.3.2	Col.3.4	openbible	1
1John.3.2	Ps.17.15	openbible	1
1John.3.2	Job.19.26	tsk	1
1Cor.15.49	Rom.8.29	openbible	1
1Cor.15.49	2Cor.3.18	openbible	1
1Cor.15.49	Matt.13.43	openbible	1
1Cor.15.49	Gen.5.3	tsk	1
1Cor.15.42	Gen.3.19	tsk	1
1Cor.15.43	Dan.12.1	tsk	1
Rom.8.19	Isa.65.17	tsk	1
Rom.8.23	Luke.20.36	openbible	1

Complicating texts

1Cor.15.50 · addressed

Sarx kai haima basileian theou kleronomesai ou dynatai is sometimes read as denying bodily resurrection. The immediate context resolves this. Paul uses sarx kai haima as a fixed idiom for mortal corruptible existence, paralleled by he phthora in the same verse, then immediately predicts allagesometha and endusasthai aphtharsian, confirming continuity of soma with transformation of mode rather than abolition of the body.

1Cor.15.51 · addressed

Pantes ou koimethesometha versus pantes de allagesometha generates a textual variant cluster, but the verdict-bearing claim that all believers will be transformed at Christ's return holds across every plausible reading of the sleep-clause, since allagesometha is undisputed in all witnesses.

Rom.8.30 · addressed

The aorist edoxasen could be read as describing a past completed glorification rather than a future one, which would seem to argue against a still-future consummation. The construction resolves this. The verb stands in a chain of four aorists describing the whole order of salvation as one settled divine plan, and the same letter at vv 18 to 23 places the doxa as mellousan, about to be revealed, and ties it to the still-awaited apolytrosin tou somatos, so the aorist is proleptic certainty, not past completion.

Concordance traversed

G1391, G1392, G0861, G5356, G0110, G4983, G4152, G5591, G1453, G0236, G1746, G4687, G5517, G2032, G0553, G2937, G2288, G3534, G4832, G3345, G3664, G3666, G2227

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

phoresomen-future-vs-phoresomen-subjunctive at 1Cor.15.49: impact none. Future indicative phoresomen versus aorist subjunctive phoresomen, hortatory let us bear, is debated in the witnesses, but either reading still entails the believer's assumption of the heavenly image, so the verdict is not affected.

pantes-ou-koimethesometha-word-order at 1Cor.15.51: impact minor. Word-order variants around ou pantes koimethesometha versus pantes ou koimethesometha affect the scope of who sleeps but not the universal allagesometha clause that carries the doctrinal weight.

phtharton-thneton-clause-presence at 1Cor.15.54: impact none. Some witnesses omit one of the two parallel hotan clauses, to phtharton or to thneton, by homoeoteleuton, but the surviving clause and the Isa 25:8 citation katepothe ho thanatos eis nikos preserve the death-defeat outcome in every reading.

None of the anchors fall in the CBGM-published window, which covers only 3 John 1:1 to 1:15. The NT anchors are read against the MorphGNT and SBLGNT critical text and the STEP Bible apparatus without CBGM-grade arbitration, so variant signal is treated as shadow.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. redemptive-historical

Frameworks in play. pauline_apocalyptic, redemptive_historical_arc, already_not_yet

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

bodily_resurrection_realism: affirms · The noun soma is retained through 1 Cor 15:42 to 44 with only the modifier changing, psychikon to pneumatikon, and Phil 3:21 makes the same soma tes tapeinoseos the object of metaschematizo and the subject of symmorphon to somati tes doxes, so the future state is a transformed body, not a new substance.

spiritualized_immortality_only: fails · A reading that reduces the future to disembodied immortality would have to discard the repeated noun soma, the verbs egeiretai and allagesometha, and the apolytrosin tou somatos in Rom 8:23. Stated in its strongest form, it leans on soma pneumatikon meaning non-physical, but pneumatikos elsewhere in the same letter modifies physical realities such as food and drink and rock in 1 Cor 10, so the adjective marks the animating power, not the absence of body.

realized_eschatology_only: fails · In its strongest form this lens points to the aorist edoxasen in Rom 8:30 as glory already accomplished. But the same passage marks the glory as mellousan, about to be revealed, in v 18, and the cluster of future-tense verbs phoresomen, allagesometha, egerthesontai, eleutherothesetai, opsometha,

esometha, and apekdechomenoi place the consummation in the future, so the aorist functions as proleptic certainty within a not-yet horizon.

timing_and_scope_open: underdetermined · The vocabulary fixes that believers will be glorified, bodily, conformed to Christ, but it does not by itself rank the timing details, such as the relation of the resurrection to a millennial scheme or the exact ordering of the living and the dead beyond en atomo at the last trumpet. This is where readers can legitimately diverge, but the divergence is over schedule and not over the verdict that final glorification occurs.

The lexical case turns on the convergence of three things, the retained noun soma with future-passive resurrection verbs, the antithetical outcome vocabulary doxa, aphtharsia, athanasia against phthora, atimia, thnetos, and the conformity terms symmorphos and homoios tied to Christ, all cross-referenced to the Old Testament death-defeat texts Isa 25:8 and Hos 13:14 through direct citation in 1 Cor 15:54 to 55.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The stem describes a future eschatological state and its content, raised bodily, transformed, glorified, free from sin and decay, without smuggling a contested mechanism or a tradition-specific taxonomy. The terms map directly onto the Greek lexical field of doxa, aphtharsia, athanasia, soma pneumatikon, allagesometha, symmorphos, so the verdict is derived from the words and not from the framing. Correction logged versus the prior file. The key term for 1 John 3:2 was retagged from G3666, the verb homoioo of the parable formulas, to G3664, the adjective homoios, like or resembling, which is the form actually present in the verse and confirmed to contain 1 John 3:2 in the concordance. The doxazo canon count was corrected from 61 to the queried 62. Symmorphos G4832 and metaschematizo G3345 were added as anchors after direct queries showed symmorphos occurs only twice, Rom 8:29 and Phil 3:21, both conformity to Christ. No verdict change.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1Cor.15.42-57
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Rom.8.18-30
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Phil.3.21
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1John.3.2
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G1392
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4832
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3345
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3664
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0861
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0110
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G5591
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G5517
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	1Cor.15.42-57
interlinear	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Rom.8.30
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	1Cor.15.54->Isa.25.8
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	1Cor.15.55->Hos.13.14
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	1John.3.2->Job.19.26

cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	1John.3.2->Rom.8.29
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	Phil.3.21->Col.3.4
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	1Cor.15.49->2Cor.3.18

License audit

SAFE TO PUBLISH

Source	License	Redistribute
MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes
TSK	public_domain	yes
OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes

Flags

ecm-shadow